Praise of the Great Vajradhara

Mahāvajradharastotra · Toh 1126 · Derge Tengyur

རྡོར་འཆང་ཆེན་པོའི་བསྟོད་པ

Praise of the Great Vajradhara, known in Sanskrit as the Mahāvajradharastotra and in Tibetan as Dorjé Chang Chenpö Töpa, is a short hymn in verse presented as the words of the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, who praises the Blessed One, the great Vajradhara, with what the text calls a king of praises. Its eight stanzas hail Vajradhara as the inseparability of the conventional and ultimate truths, as a body of space free of conceptual thought and of intrinsic nature, and as the five aggregates purified into the five buddhas, and they honor him through images of a ship's captain, a vajra master, a king of physicians, and a great lotus unstained by the mud of concepts. The colophon states that the praise comes from a tantra called the Tantra of Great Space, and that the Zhalu translator Dharmapāla rendered it into Tibetan at the hermitage of Densa Thel, at the command of the venerable great elder known by the title Chennga. It is Toh 1126 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of praises (stotra), and it joins Mahāyāna teaching on the two truths and emptiness to the devotional language of the tantras.

In the language of India: mahāvajradharastotra. In the language of Tibet: Praise of the Great Vajradhara.

Homage to all the perfect buddhas who dwell in the ten directions, as far as the extremes of space, to the vajra goddesses, to the bodhisattvas, to the wrathful kings, and to all the rest.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi praised the Blessed One, the great Vajradhara, with this king of praises:

Homage to the conventional truth!
Homage to you, the ultimate!
Homage to the inseparability of the two truths!
Homage to you, the vajra body!

Your body, speech, and mind are pure;
Your body is from the very beginning a body of space,
Free of conceptual thought, without any object of reference:
Homage to you who are without intrinsic nature!

Without conceptual thoughts of virtue and nonvirtue,
Without mental engagement and without volition,

By nature you are like space:
Vajrasattva, homage to you!

The five aggregates, which revolve
Through the workings of saṃsāra, are completely pure,
The essential nature of the five buddhas:
Homage to you who abide in space!

For the sake of embodied beings who wander,
Lacking full knowledge, in the ocean of saṃsāra,
You hold the oar of full knowledge:
Homage to you, the captain!

With regard to permanence, impermanence, and the rest,
By way of permanence, impermanence, and the rest,
You are skilled in teaching the completely pure path:
Vajra master, homage to you!

Those of our own school and those of other schools
Who are stricken with the fever of views
Are the sick whom you heal:
King of physicians, homage to you!

Your pure body, unstained
By the mud of manifold conceptual thoughts,
Naturally abides in luminosity:
Great lotus, homage to you!

This completes the Praise of the Great Vajradhara, composed by Vajrapāṇi, as it appears in the Tantra of Great Space.

At the command of the venerable great elder Chennga, the embodiment of glorious Vajradhara, the Zhalu translator Dharmapāla translated it at the hermitage of glorious Densa Thel.

Translator's Notes

• Three evident copyists' slips are translated in their plain readings: □□□□ for □□□□□ ("directions") in the opening homage, □□□□□□ for □□□□□□□ in "bodhisattva," and □□□□□□□ for □□□□□□ ("impermanence") in the second line of the sixth stanza. In the fourth stanza □□□□ is the verb "to revolve," playing on □□□□□□, saṃsāra; it is not "retinue" here. The sixth stanza is terse: it appears to say that the vajra master teaches the pure path to those attached to notions such as permanence and impermanence by means of those same notions. I could not identify the

Sanskrit title of the tantra named □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, so I have translated it as "the Tantra of Great Space." Chennga (□□□□□□□□) is an honorific title, not a personal name.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.